

GISHAN NISSANKA

ENTERPRISE AI & DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION LEADER | SPEAKER

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Gishan Nissanka is an enterprise AI and digital transformation leader with 20 years of international experience helping large, complex organisations turn technology, data and AI into practical organisational capability. His career spans Vodafone, Ernst & Young, Worldline and Nscale, where he has led work across enterprise platforms, data strategy, analytics, operating models, workforce intelligence, responsible AI and executive decision support.

His work sits at the point where technology meets people and organisational change. He has advised executive teams, built global analytics and transformation capabilities, established off-shore centres of excellence, led major technology selections and created AI-enabled solutions with measurable improvements in productivity, data quality and adoption. His perspective is grounded in delivery: AI creates value only when leaders are clear about the problem, the data is trusted, work is redesigned and employees have the confidence and skills to adopt it.

AREAS OF CONTRIBUTION

Human-Centric AI | Enterprise AI Adoption | Digital Transformation | Responsible AI & Trust | Workforce and Skills Transformation | AI-Enabled Operating Models | Data Governance | Leadership Adoption

CURRENT LEADERSHIP & ADVISORY WORK

Nissanka AI Advisory. Gishan is the founder of Nissanka AI Advisory, where he advises organisations on AI readiness, responsible adoption, workforce intelligence and the redesign of work around human-AI collaboration. He develops practical transformation roadmaps connecting business value, governance, operating models, leadership behaviour and workforce capability.

CAREER EXPERIENCE

At **Nscale**, Gishan served as Director of People Technology & Analytics, establishing the technology, data and governance foundations needed to support rapid international growth.

He led the end-to-end selection and Executive Committee business case for Workday HCM, designed the global technology and data migration roadmap, and introduced AI-enabled employee insight and executive workforce reporting.

At **Worldline**, a global financial technology organisation, he was Head of People Intelligence with responsibility for data, analytics, workforce planning and AI transformation across more than 20,000 employees in over 50 countries. He established the company's first offshore People Analytics Centre of Excellence in India, improved core data accuracy from 70% to 98%, and secured sponsorship for a GenAI strategy and governance roadmap. The adoption programme increased AI use by 50% in seven months and achieved full leadership adoption.

During seven years with **Ernst & Young Global**, Gishan held leadership roles across people analytics consulting, digital talent, data architecture and global transformation. Working across seven regions and a wider footprint of 145 countries, he led analytics business partners, built virtual centres of excellence in India and the Philippines, and developed transformation roadmaps for regional leadership teams. He also led EY Insights, a global self-service decision platform used by more than 1,000 users, and PX360, an AI and machine-learning-enabled workforce risk platform.

Gishan began his transformation career at **Vodafone Group**, where he worked across data analytics, HR systems and global reporting. He defined reporting strategy for a 91,000-employee organisation spanning 21 operating companies, helped move reporting into shared services in Pune, and transformed fragmented SAP reporting into a global business intelligence platform. He later led the HR technology integration for Vodafone's EUR 7 billion acquisition of Kabel Deutschland, covering approximately 4,000 employees across 13 locations.

SELECTED ORGANISATIONAL IMPACT

Across these roles, Gishan's work has included an estimated US\$3.5 million in annual efficiency value at EY, approximately EUR 512,000 in combined annual efficiency and validation savings at Worldline, a rise in core data quality from 70% to 98%, and a 60% improvement in reporting efficiency across Vodafone's 21 operating companies. He has built and led cross-functional and international teams while working with senior executives, Finance, Technology, Security, Compliance and Data Protection stakeholders.

SPEAKING, TEACHING & INDUSTRY CONTRIBUTION

Gishan has delivered more than 50 keynotes, conference presentations, panels and leadership sessions. His international speaking experience includes the Chief AI Officer Summit UK, TechEx London and Amsterdam, CWI Dubai, CDAO UK, People Analytics World and the CIPD Annual Conference. His speaking focuses on practical AI adoption, responsible AI, workforce transformation, people and data strategy, and the future of work.

He has served as a Guest Lecturer at University College London and as an Associate Lecturer at

Buckinghamshire New University, connecting academic thinking with the realities of enterprise implementation and organisational change.

EDUCATION & EXECUTIVE DEVELOPMENT

Gishan completed the Artificial Intelligence Programme at the University of Oxford and the Ethics of AI programme at the London School of Economics. He holds an MSc in Business Information Technology from Buckinghamshire New University, an MBA from Buckinghamshire Business School, and a Postgraduate Diploma in Marketing from the Chartered Institute of Marketing.